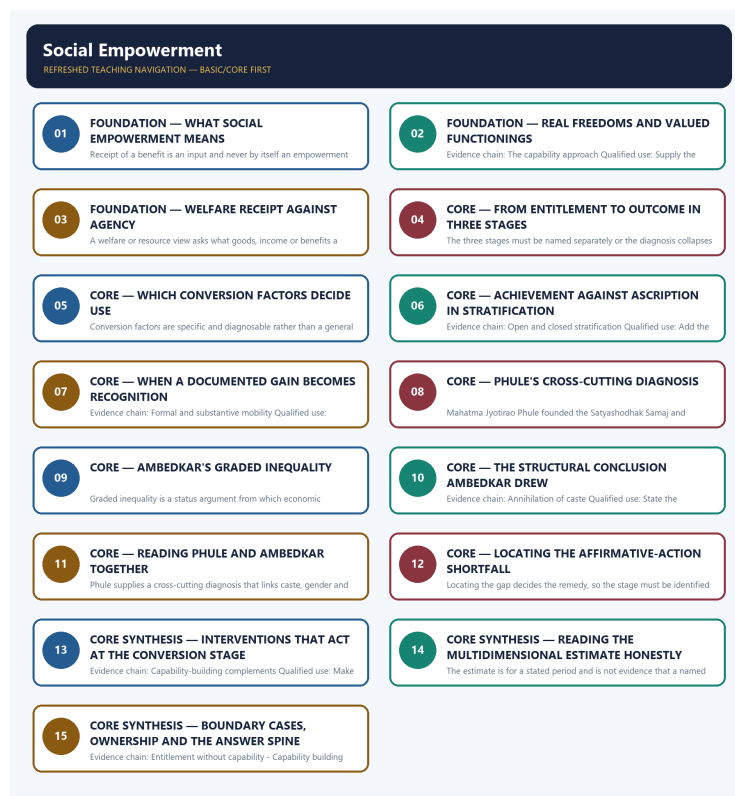


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Social Empowerment - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Social Empowerment - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-02. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-02.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. The OCR-searchable official General Studies Paper-I question papers held under books\mains and books\more_previous_papers were used only to confirm the wording of routed Mains PYQs. No official answer key, marking scheme, page precision or unsupported quotation was imported from them.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** Two direct General Studies Paper-I Mains demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table and each is recorded with its exact routing status, because in both cases the audited ledger names a different owner. The 2024 Q18 demand on underprivileged sections not yet receiving the full benefits of affirmative action is routed in the audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger to the Social Justice concept-and-welfare-state owner, while this owner's table claims it as a core route. The 2025 Q11 demand on Mahatma Jotirao Phule's writings and social reform efforts is routed in the same ledger to the Modern Indian History socio-religious reform-movements owner, while this owner's table claims it as a core route. Both conflicts are stated openly here and neither is resolved by assertion; the answers below are written strictly from the Social Empowerment sociological spine and claim no reservation doctrine, welfare-scheme architecture or reform-movement chronology owned elsewhere. The wording of both demands was confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 General Studies Paper-I question papers. No marking scheme, official key or model answer of the Union Public Service Commission is held locally, and none is reproduced or inferred.
- **Live-link boundary:** No additional live official item was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. Only the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners are used, each with its issuing body and date. The package invents no caste, tribe, demographic or agrarian statistic, no legal or constitutional claim and no policy status.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Indian Society Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Concept method	Define and distinguish the institution, identity, process, legal category and measured indicator before analysis.
Sociological method	Structure/institution -> mechanism and agency -> differentiated group/region outcome -> feedback, resistance and qualification.
Evidence method	Claim -> named Indian community/region/institution/dataset -> analysis -> source-date-status or causal qualification.
Non-homogenisation	Caste, tribe, women, religion, region and rural/urban groups retain internal class, gender, locality and historical variation.
Boundary method	Constitutional right, statutory mandate, executive scheme, implementation and lived social outcome remain distinct.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, a detailed examiner-grade model, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Indian-Society\basic\08_Social-Empowerment.md **Canonical topic owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Indian-Society\basic\08_Social-Empowerment.md **Optional Advanced owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Indian-Society\advanced\08_Social-Empowerment.md **Official syllabus mapping:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Indian-Society\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- **Definition discipline:** close concepts and legal-administrative categories share a comparison axis and are never treated as synonyms.
- **Mechanism discipline:** correlation, temporal sequence and aggregate association do not establish causation; identify institutions, incentives, norms, power and agency.
- **Historical discipline:** colonial, constitutional, developmental, liberalisation and contemporary phases are separated without a linear tradition-to-modernity story.
- **Intersectional discipline:** overlapping caste, tribe, class, gender, religion, disability, region and life-course positions are analysed without creating a single homogeneous category.
- **India discipline:** use named communities, movements, institutions, cities, states and regional contrasts without stereotyping or treating one case as nationally representative.
- **Data discipline:** Census 2011, NFHS, PLFS, SRS, Agriculture Census, MPI and scheme claims retain source, reference period, release date, coverage and provisional/final status.
- **PYQ discipline:** repository routing ledgers and locally held papers control wording and metadata; reconstructed wording and unavailable official keys remain labelled.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-02:** No additional live official item was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. Only the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners are used, each with its issuing body and date. The package invents no caste, tribe, demographic or agrarian statistic, no legal or constitutional claim and no policy status.

Live/official context sources recorded by the predecessor generation:

- No volatile live claim is necessary for the static sociological core.



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - WHAT SOCIAL EMPOWERMENT MEANS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over.

Technical definition: Receipt of a benefit is an input and never by itself an empowerment outcome.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- What social empowerment means
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Social empowerment
- Social

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define What social empowerment means, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Social empowerment for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WHAT SOCIAL EMPOWERMENT MEANS

01. Empowerment against welfare receipt

BOUNDARY -> Receipt of a benefit is an input and never by itself an empowerment outcome.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Receipt of a benefit is an input and never by itself an empowerment outcome.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to What social empowerment means.
- **Mains:** Open an empowerment answer with the outcome question rather than a scheme list.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Empowerment against welfare receipt
- **Qualified use:** Open an empowerment answer with the outcome question rather than a scheme list.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - WHAT SOCIAL EMPOWERMENT MEANS

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - What social empowerment means

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · What social empowerment means · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Social empowerment · Social

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Prelims: Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to What social empowerment means.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Evidence chain: Empowerment against welfare receipt Qualified use: Open an empowerment answer with the outcome question rather than a scheme list.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Receipt of a benefit is an input and never by itself an empowerment outcome.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - REAL FREEDOMS AND VALUED FUNCTIONINGS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The capability approach Qualified use: Supply the master frame that the whole topic is built on.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Real freedoms**
- **valued functionings**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Amartya Sen's**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Real freedoms, connect valued functionings with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

REAL FREEDOMS AND VALUED FUNCTIONINGS

01. The capability approach

BOUNDARY -> Capability analysis does not make welfare inputs unimportant.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Capability analysis does not make welfare inputs unimportant.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Real freedoms and valued functionings.
- **Mains:** Supply the master frame that the whole topic is built on.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The capability approach
- **Qualified use:** Supply the master frame that the whole topic is built on.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - REAL FREEDOMS AND VALUED FUNCTIONINGS

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Real freedoms and valued functionings

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Real freedoms · valued functionings · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Amartya Sen's

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: The capability approach Qualified use: Supply the master frame that the whole topic is built on.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Capability analysis does not make welfare inputs unimportant.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: supply the master frame that the whole topic is built on.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - WELFARE RECEIPT AGAINST AGENCY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Agency view against welfare view Qualified use: Separate two legitimate but different measurement questions.

Technical definition: A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Agency view against welfare view Qualified use: Separate two legitimate but different measurement questions.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Welfare receipt against agency
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Agency
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Welfare receipt against agency, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Agency for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WELFARE RECEIPT AGAINST AGENCY

01. Agency view against welfare view

BOUNDARY -> A welfare view remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone proves nothing about agency.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- A welfare view remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone proves nothing about agency.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Welfare receipt against agency.
- **Mains:** Separate two legitimate but different measurement questions.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Agency view against welfare view
- **Qualified use:** Separate two legitimate but different measurement questions.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - WELFARE RECEIPT AGAINST AGENCY

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Welfare receipt against agency

|
v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Welfare receipt against agency · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Agency
· Qualified

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: A welfare view remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone proves nothing about agency.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: agency view against welfare view
Qualified use.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Agency view against welfare view Qualified use:
Separate two legitimate but different measurement questions.

SESSION 4 - CORE - FROM ENTITLEMENT TO OUTCOME IN THREE STAGES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

Technical definition: The three stages must be named separately or the diagnosis collapses into a general complaint.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- From entitlement to outcome in three stages
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Empowerment
- Advanced
- Three-stage

How to use them: Frame the answer through From entitlement to outcome in three stages; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Empowerment to explain the mechanism, and use Advanced for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

FROM ENTITLEMENT TO OUTCOME IN THREE STAGES

01. Three-stage conversion chain

BOUNDARY -> The three stages must be named separately or the diagnosis collapses into a general complaint.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The three stages must be named separately or the diagnosis collapses into a general complaint.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to From entitlement to outcome in three stages.

- **Mains:** Give the structure that turns an implementation grievance into an analysis.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Three-stage conversion chain
- **Qualified use:** Give the structure that turns an implementation grievance into an analysis.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - FROM ENTITLEMENT TO OUTCOME IN THREE STAGES

START / CONCEPT: CORE - From entitlement to outcome in three stages

|

v

EXACT TERMS: From entitlement to outcome in three stages · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Empowerment · Advanced · Three-stage

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The three stages must be named separately or the diagnosis collapses into a general complaint.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Evidence chain: Three-stage conversion chain Qualified use: Give the structure that turns an implementation grievance into an analysis.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

SESSION 5 - CORE - WHICH CONVERSION FACTORS DECIDE USE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage.

Technical definition: Conversion factors are specific and diagnosable rather than a general reference to poor implementation.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Prelims: Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Which conversion factors decide use.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Which conversion factors decide use**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Conversion factors**
- **Conversion**
- **Retain**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Which conversion factors decide use; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Conversion factors to explain the mechanism, and use Conversion for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WHICH CONVERSION FACTORS DECIDE USE

01. Naming the conversion factors

BOUNDARY -> Conversion factors are specific and diagnosable rather than a general reference to poor implementation.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Conversion factors are specific and diagnosable rather than a general reference to poor implementation.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Which conversion factors decide use.
- **Mains:** Name the exact mechanisms that a comment directive expects.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Naming the conversion factors
- **Qualified use:** Name the exact mechanisms that a comment directive expects.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - WHICH CONVERSION FACTORS DECIDE USE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Which conversion factors decide use

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Which conversion factors decide use · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Conversion factors · Conversion · Retain

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Evidence chain: Naming the conversion factors Qualified use: Name the exact mechanisms that a comment directive expects.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Conversion factors are specific and diagnosable rather than a general reference to poor implementation.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Prelims: Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Which conversion factors decide use.

SESSION 6 - CORE - ACHIEVEMENT AGAINST ASCRIPTION IN STRATIFICATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Open and closed stratification Qualified use: Add the standard sociological device for a mobility question.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Achievement against ascription in stratification
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- India
- Contemporary openness
- Contemporary

How to use them: Frame the answer through Achievement against ascription in stratification; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with India to explain the mechanism, and use Contemporary openness for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

ACHIEVEMENT AGAINST ASCRIPTION IN STRATIFICATION

01. Open and closed stratification

BOUNDARY -> Contemporary openness is real but uneven, so neither pure type describes India.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Contemporary openness is real but uneven, so neither pure type describes India.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Achievement against ascription in stratification.
- **Mains:** Add the standard sociological device for a mobility question.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Open and closed stratification
- **Qualified use:** Add the standard sociological device for a mobility question.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - ACHIEVEMENT AGAINST ASCRIPTION IN STRATIFICATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Achievement against ascription in stratification

|

↓

EXACT TERMS: Achievement against ascription in stratification · Evidence chain · Qualified use · India · Contemporary openness · Contemporary

|

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Open and closed stratification Qualified use: Add the standard sociological device for a mobility question.

|

↓

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Contemporary openness is real but uneven, so neither pure type describes India.

|

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: an open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual...

|

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.

SESSION 7 - CORE - WHEN A DOCUMENTED GAIN BECOMES RECOGNITION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Formal and substantive mobility Qualified use: Convert a mobility demand into an outcome-quality argument.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- When a documented gain becomes recognition
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Formal mobility
- Formal
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through When a documented gain becomes recognition; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Formal mobility to explain the mechanism, and use Formal for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WHEN A DOCUMENTED GAIN BECOMES RECOGNITION

01. Formal and substantive mobility

BOUNDARY -> Neither stigma nor recognition may be inferred from income or occupation alone.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Neither stigma nor recognition may be inferred from income or occupation alone.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to When a documented gain becomes recognition.
- **Mains:** Convert a mobility demand into an outcome-quality argument.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Formal and substantive mobility
- **Qualified use:** Convert a mobility demand into an outcome-quality argument.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - WHEN A DOCUMENTED GAIN BECOMES RECOGNITION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - When a documented gain becomes recognition

|

v

EXACT TERMS: When a documented gain becomes recognition · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Formal mobility · Formal · Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Formal and substantive mobility Qualified use: Convert a mobility demand into an outcome-quality argument.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

SESSION 8 - CORE - PHULE'S CROSS-CUTTING DIAGNOSIS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Phule's cross-cutting critique - Education as Phule's chosen lever
Qualified use: Prove the almost-all-subaltern-classes claim with three named axes.

Technical definition: Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of

disadvantage at a time.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Phule's cross-cutting critique - Education as Phule's chosen lever Qualified use: Prove the almost-all-subaltern-classes claim with three named axes.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Phule's cross-cutting diagnosis**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Mahatma Jyotirao Phule**
- **Satyashodhak Samaj**
- **Brahminical**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Phule's cross-cutting diagnosis; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Mahatma Jyotirao Phule to explain the mechanism, and use Satyashodhak Samaj for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PHULE'S CROSS-CUTTING DIAGNOSIS

01. Phule's cross-cutting critique

|

v

02. Education as Phule's chosen lever

BOUNDARY -> Reform-movement chronology is owned by Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time.
- Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Reform-movement chronology is owned by Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Phule's cross-cutting diagnosis.
- **Mains:** Prove the almost-all-subaltern-classes claim with three named axes.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Phule's cross-cutting critique -> Education as Phule's chosen lever
- **Qualified use:** Prove the almost-all-subaltern-classes claim with three named axes.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - PHULE'S CROSS-CUTTING DIAGNOSIS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Phule's cross-cutting diagnosis

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Phule's cross-cutting diagnosis · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Mahatma Jyotirao Phule · Satyashodhak Samaj · Brahminical

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Reform-movement chronology is owned by Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Phule's cross-cutting critique - Education as Phule's chosen lever Qualified use: Prove the almost-all-subaltern-classes claim with three named axes.

SESSION 9 - CORE - AMBEDKAR'S GRADED INEQUALITY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Ambedkar's graded inequality - Why graded inequality is self-reinforcing

Qualified use: Explain why formal equality coexists with informal hierarchy.

Technical definition: Graded inequality is a status argument from which economic consequence follows, not the reverse.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Ambedkar's graded inequality - Why graded inequality is self-reinforcing Qualified use: Explain why formal equality coexists with informal hierarchy.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Ambedkar's graded inequality
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Ambedkar
- Because
- Graded inequality

How to use them: Frame the answer through Ambedkar's graded inequality; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Ambedkar to explain the mechanism, and use Because for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

AMBEDKAR'S GRADED INEQUALITY

01. Ambedkar's graded inequality

|
v

02. Why graded inequality is self-reinforcing

BOUNDARY -> Graded inequality is a status argument from which economic consequence follows, not the reverse.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above.
- Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Graded inequality is a status argument from which economic consequence follows, not the reverse.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Ambedkar's graded inequality.
- **Mains:** Explain why formal equality coexists with informal hierarchy.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Ambedkar's graded inequality -> Why graded inequality is self-reinforcing
- **Qualified use:** Explain why formal equality coexists with informal hierarchy.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - AMBEDKAR'S GRADED INEQUALITY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Ambedkar's graded inequality

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Ambedkar's graded inequality · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Ambedkar · Because · Graded inequality

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Graded inequality is a status argument from which economic consequence follows, not the reverse.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Ambedkar's graded inequality - Why graded inequality is self-reinforcing Qualified use: Explain why formal equality coexists with informal hierarchy.

SESSION 10 - CORE - THE STRUCTURAL CONCLUSION AMBEDKAR DREW

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Annihilation of caste Qualified use: State the structural conclusion precisely rather than as a slogan.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The structural conclusion Ambedkar drew
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Annihilation of caste
- Annihilation
- Ambedkar's

How to use them: Frame the answer through The structural conclusion Ambedkar drew; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Annihilation of caste to explain the mechanism, and use Annihilation for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE STRUCTURAL CONCLUSION AMBEDKAR DREW

01. Annihilation of caste

BOUNDARY -> Constitutional and reservation doctrine belongs to Polity and Social Justice.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Constitutional and reservation doctrine belongs to Polity and Social Justice.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to The structural conclusion Ambedkar drew.
- **Mains:** State the structural conclusion precisely rather than as a slogan.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Annihilation of caste
- **Qualified use:** State the structural conclusion precisely rather than as a slogan.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE STRUCTURAL CONCLUSION AMBEDKAR DREW

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The structural conclusion Ambedkar drew

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The structural conclusion Ambedkar drew • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Annihilation of caste • Annihilation • Ambedkar's

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Annihilation of caste Qualified use: State the structural conclusion precisely rather than as a slogan.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that state the structural conclusion precisely rather than as a slogan.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: state the structural conclusion precisely rather than as a slogan.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.

SESSION 11 - CORE - READING PHULE AND AMBEDKAR TOGETHER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Phule and Ambedkar as complementary Qualified use: Use two named diagnoses instead of one generalised reform narrative.

Technical definition: Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Reading Phule
- Ambedkar together
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Phule
- Ambedkar

How to use them: Frame the answer through Reading Phule; define Ambedkar together, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Phule for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

READING PHULE AND AMBEDKAR TOGETHER

01. Phule and Ambedkar as complementary

BOUNDARY -> The two diagnoses are complementary tools and must not be collapsed into one tradition.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The two diagnoses are complementary tools and must not be collapsed into one tradition.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Reading Phule and Ambedkar together.
- **Mains:** Use two named diagnoses instead of one generalised reform narrative.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Phule and Ambedkar as complementary
- **Qualified use:** Use two named diagnoses instead of one generalised reform narrative.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - READING PHULE AND AMBEDKAR TOGETHER

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Reading Phule and Ambedkar together

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Reading Phule · Ambedkar together · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Phule · Ambedkar

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Phule and Ambedkar as complementary Qualified use: Use two named diagnoses instead of one generalised reform narrative.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The two diagnoses are complementary tools and must not be collapsed into one tradition.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: use two named diagnoses instead of one generalised reform narrative.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.

SESSION 12 - CORE - LOCATING THE AFFIRMATIVE-ACTION SHORTFALL

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Where the affirmative-action gap sits Qualified use: Answer a comment directive by diagnosing rather than by lamenting.

Technical definition: Locating the gap decides the remedy, so the stage must be identified before any recommendation.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Where the affirmative-action gap sits Qualified use: Answer a comment directive by diagnosing rather than by lamenting.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Locating the affirmative-action shortfall
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Locating
- Where
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through Locating the affirmative-action shortfall; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Locating to explain the mechanism, and use Where for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

LOCATING THE AFFIRMATIVE-ACTION SHORTFALL

01. Where the affirmative-action gap sits

BOUNDARY -> Locating the gap decides the remedy, so the stage must be identified before any recommendation.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Locating the gap decides the remedy, so the stage must be identified before any recommendation.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Locating the affirmative-action shortfall.
- **Mains:** Answer a comment directive by diagnosing rather than by lamenting.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Where the affirmative-action gap sits
- **Qualified use:** Answer a comment directive by diagnosing rather than by lamenting.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - LOCATING THE AFFIRMATIVE-ACTION SHORTFALL

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Locating the affirmative-action shortfall

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Locating the affirmative-action shortfall · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Locating
· Where · Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Locating the gap decides the remedy, so the stage must be identified before any recommendation.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: where the affirmative-action gap sits Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Where the affirmative-action gap sits Qualified use:
Answer a comment directive by diagnosing rather than by lamenting.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - INTERVENTIONS THAT ACT AT THE CONVERSION STAGE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Capability-building complements Qualified use: Make the recommendation concrete and stage-specific.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Interventions that act at the conversion stage
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Early-childhood
- Capability-building

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Interventions that act at the conversion stage, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Early-childhood for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

INTERVENTIONS THAT ACT AT THE CONVERSION STAGE

01. Capability-building complements

BOUNDARY -> These interventions complement entitlement rather than replacing it.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- These interventions complement entitlement rather than replacing it.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Interventions that act at the conversion stage.
- **Mains:** Make the recommendation concrete and stage-specific.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Capability-building complements
- **Qualified use:** Make the recommendation concrete and stage-specific.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - INTERVENTIONS THAT ACT AT THE CONVERSION STAGE

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Interventions that act at the conversion stage

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Interventions that act at the conversion stage · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Early-childhood · Capability-building

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Capability-building complements Qualified use: Make the recommendation concrete and stage-specific.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are...

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - READING THE MULTIDIMENSIONAL ESTIMATE HONESTLY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.

Technical definition: The estimate is for a stated period and is not evidence that a named programme caused the change.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Reading the multidimensional estimate honestly
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- 2005-06
- 2022-23

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Reading the multidimensional estimate honestly, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use 2005-06 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

READING THE MULTIDIMENSIONAL ESTIMATE HONESTLY

01. Dated multidimensional anchor

BOUNDARY -> The estimate is for a stated period and is not evidence that a named programme caused the change.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The estimate is for a stated period and is not evidence that a named programme caused the change.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Reading the multidimensional estimate honestly.

- **Mains:** Cite one dated official estimate without converting it into a current count.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Dated multidimensional anchor
- **Qualified use:** Cite one dated official estimate without converting it into a current count.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - READING THE MULTIDIMENSIONAL ESTIMATE HONESTLY

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Reading the multidimensional estimate honestly

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Reading the multidimensional estimate honestly · Evidence chain · Qualified use · 2005-06 · 2022-23

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v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Dated multidimensional anchor Qualified use: Cite one dated official estimate without converting it into a current count.

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v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The estimate is for a stated period and is not evidence that a named programme caused the change.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the estimate is for a stated period and is not evidence that a named...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - BOUNDARY CASES, OWNERSHIP AND THE ANSWER SPINE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: CORE SYNTHESIS - Boundary cases, ownership and the answer spine comprises CORE SYNTHESIS, Boundary cases and ownership as its core connected dimensions.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Entitlement without capability - Capability building that works - Formal mobility without recognition - Examination ownership audit Qualified use: Assemble the empowerment answer spine with honest question ownership.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **Boundary cases**
- **ownership**
- **the answer spine**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Boundary cases, connect ownership with the answer spine to explain the mechanism, and use Evidence chain for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

BOUNDARY CASES, OWNERSHIP AND THE ANSWER SPINE

01. Entitlement without capability

|

v

02. Capability building that works

|

v

03. Formal mobility without recognition

|

v

04. Examination ownership audit

BOUNDARY -> Two claimed demands are routed elsewhere in the ledgers, and the conflict is recorded rather than hidden.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer.
- A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical.
- A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility.
- Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Two claimed demands are routed elsewhere in the ledgers, and the conflict is recorded rather than hidden.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact unit, named scholar, official category, dated statistic or legal boundary attached to Boundary cases, ownership and the answer spine.
- **Mains:** Assemble the empowerment answer spine with honest question ownership.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Entitlement without capability -> Capability building that works -> Formal mobility without recognition -> Examination ownership audit

- **Qualified use:** Assemble the empowerment answer spine with honest question ownership.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Indian Society | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-I. **Core area:** Empowerment as capability/agency (Sen), social mobility theory, Phule and Ambedkar as sociological reformers, and the affirmative-action-outcome gap. **Grounded in:** Amartya Sen's capability approach; Mahatma Jyotirao Phule's writings on subaltern classes; B.R. Ambedkar's caste-annihilation sociology; NITI Aayog's 2024 multidimensional-poverty discussion paper; audited 2024 and 2025 GS-I Mains PYQs. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* advanced/08_Social-Empowerment.md.

1. Visual foundation

```

WELFARE (instrumentalist: give resources/benefits)
  |
  v
CAPABILITY/AGENCY (Sen: expand what a person can
                  actually do and be)
  |
  v
SOCIAL MOBILITY THEORY
OPEN SYSTEM (achievement-based movement possible)
  |
  v
CLOSED SYSTEM (ascriptive status largely fixed)
  |
  v
SOCIOLOGICAL REFORM DIAGNOSIS
PHULE (satyashodhak critique of Brahminical
      dominance, education for all "subaltern"
      classes incl. women, peasants, lower castes)
  +
  AMBEDKAR (caste as graded inequality, annihilation
           of caste, not mere reform, as the goal)
  |
  v
POLICY-PRACTICE GAP
formal affirmative action  vs  lived empowerment outcome

```

Core proposition: ANALYSIS: Social empowerment is not exhausted by delivery of welfare benefits; it concerns expansion of capability and agency (Sen), and India's own sociological reform tradition - Phule's critique of Brahminical dominance and Ambedkar's diagnosis of caste as graded inequality - anticipated that formal legal equality alone would not close the gap between policy design and lived empowerment, a gap the 2024 PYQ explicitly tests.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Capability approach (Amartya Sen)	Development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms and capabilities a person has to achieve valued functionings (being educated, being healthy, participating in public life), not merely by resources or income received.
ANALYSIS: Agency vs welfare view	A welfare/resource view asks what income, goods or benefits a person receives; an agency view also asks whether the person can make and act on choices shaping well-being. Welfare can be rights-based and valuable, but receipt alone does not establish agency.
ANALYSIS: Social mobility (open vs closed system)	An open stratification system allows movement between social positions based on individual achievement; a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status - traditional caste society leaned closed, though contemporary India shows increasing, uneven openness.
FACT: Phule's subaltern-classes critique	Mahatma Jyotirao Phule's writings and reform efforts (education for girls and lower castes, critique of Brahminical ritual dominance) addressed the interlinked disadvantages of caste, gender and peasant classes together, not caste alone.
FACT: Ambedkar's graded inequality / annihilation of caste	B.R. Ambedkar argued caste was not simple division of labour but a graded hierarchy of inequality reproduced through religious sanction, and that the goal must be annihilation of caste as a system, not mere inter-caste social reform.

3. How empowerment and mobility function

- 1. From welfare to capability:** FACT: Sen's capability approach adds the question of real freedom (education, health, voice) to resource transfer. A person can receive a benefit and still lack the capability to use it effectively (illiteracy limiting use of a cash transfer, for example).
- 2. Social mobility as a structural question:** ANALYSIS: mobility depends on whether a society's institutions (education access, labour markets, marriage norms) reward achievement or simply reproduce ascribed status; caste historically functioned as a closed system, though Sanskritisation-based and market-based mobility (Topic 02) show partial opening.
- 3. Phule's sociological diagnosis:** FACT: Phule, working with Savitribai Phule in education and reform, identified interlocking caste, gender and peasant-class disadvantage and made education a central empowerment lever. His 2025 PYQ relevance rests on how comprehensively his writings addressed "almost all subaltern classes," not caste alone.
- 4. Ambedkar's structural diagnosis:** FACT: Ambedkar rejected reform strategies that treated caste as a set of individual prejudices, arguing instead that caste was a systemic, religiously sanctioned graded inequality requiring structural annihilation, which shaped his advocacy for constitutional safeguards and reservation.
- 5. From diagnosis to policy:** ANALYSIS: both Phule's and Ambedkar's sociological diagnoses fed into post-Independence constitutional and policy commitments to affirmative action, but translating formal policy into lived empowerment has proven a persistent gap.
- 6. The 2024 PYQ's gap:** FACT: despite comprehensive constitutional equity and affirmative-action policy, underprivileged sections have not fully received the intended benefits - implementation capacity, social stigma and unequal starting capability all limit translation of policy into outcome.

4. Institutions and concepts

- FACT: **Capability approach (Sen):** the theoretical basis for defining empowerment as expanded freedom, not just resource receipt.
- FACT: **Phule's Satyashodhak Samaj:** Phule's reform organisation challenging Brahminical

ritual dominance and promoting education for women, lower castes and peasants together - its detailed historical chronology belongs to Modern-Indian-History/basic/10_Socio-Religious-Reform-Movements.md.

- **FACT: Ambedkar's constitutional and reservation legacy:** the constitutional-doctrine and reservation-mechanism detail is Polity's and Social-Justice's territory, not re-derived here; this file covers only Ambedkar's sociological diagnosis of caste.

- **ANALYSIS: Social mobility channels:** education, urban migration, non-farm employment and Sanskritisation (Topic 02) function as the main observed mobility channels in contemporary India.

5. Indian applications and PYQ mapping

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I PYQ (15 marks, verbatim):** "Despite Comprehensive policies for equity and social justice, underprivileged sections are not yet getting the full benefits of affirmative action envisaged by the Constitution. Comment." The expected answer: affirm the gap, explain it through implementation-capacity limits, unequal starting capability (illiteracy, remoteness, information asymmetry) and residual social stigma limiting effective uptake of affirmative-action provisions, and argue for a capability-building complement to legal entitlement, not merely wider or larger entitlements alone.

- **FACT: 2025 GS-I PYQ (15 marks, verbatim):** "Mahatma Jotirao Phule's writings and efforts of social reforms touched issues of almost all subaltern classes. Discuss." The expected answer: demonstrate that Phule's reform agenda spanned caste (critique of Brahminical dominance), gender (girls' education, widow remarriage support) and peasant-class concerns (critique of exploitative agrarian relations), making his sociological diagnosis unusually comprehensive across multiple axes of subaltern disadvantage rather than caste-focused alone.

- **ANALYSIS:** A Scheduled Caste student who qualifies for a reserved seat but cannot use it effectively due to prior schooling deficits illustrates the policy-practice gap the 2024 PYQ addresses.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- **FACT:** Amartya Sen's capability approach reframes development/empowerment around real freedoms, not resources or income alone.

- **FACT:** Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and championed education for women, lower castes and peasants together.

- **FACT:** B.R. Ambedkar argued caste was a "graded inequality," not mere division of labour, and called for its "annihilation," not simple reform.

- **CURRENT:** NITI Aayog's 2024 discussion paper *Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06* estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28% in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore people exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23. Label these as the paper's estimates and time period, not a current headcount.

- **ANALYSIS:** Open versus closed stratification systems is the standard sociological device for discussing whether achievement or ascription determines social position.

7. UPSC traps

- **WRONG:** Empowerment means the same as welfare provision. -> Welfare can be valuable, but Sen's capability approach asks whether it expands real freedom and agency; receipt alone does not establish capability.

- **WRONG:** Phule's reform work addressed only caste issues. -> The 2025 PYQ specifically tests that his writings touched "almost all subaltern classes" - caste, gender and peasant-class concerns together.

- **WRONG:** Ambedkar sought to reform caste from within Hinduism. -> His later position explicitly called for "annihilation of caste" as a system, moving beyond reformist approaches that left the underlying religious sanction intact.

- **WRONG:** Constitutional affirmative-action policy alone guarantees empowerment outcomes. -> The 2024 PYQ explicitly tests the gap between policy design and lived outcome, driven by implementation capacity and unequal starting capability.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- CURRENT: NITI Aayog's 2024 discussion paper estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28% in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore exits between 2013-14 and 2022-23. State the estimate, methodology and period; do not call it a current 2026 headcount.

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2024 GS-I (15 marks)**: affirm the policy-practice gap, explain it through implementation capacity and unequal starting capability, and recommend capability-building as the complement to legal entitlement.
- FACT: **2025 GS-I (15 marks)**: demonstrate Phule's cross-cutting reform agenda (caste, gender, peasant class) with specific, named examples of his advocacy.

10. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Use Sen's capability approach as the master frame for distinguishing welfare from empowerment in any answer.
- ANALYSIS: Present Phule and Ambedkar together as complementary, not competing, sociological diagnoses of caste-linked disadvantage.
- ANALYSIS: Keep reservation/reservation-doctrine detail cross-linked to Polity/Social-Justice.

Answer thesis: Genuine social empowerment requires expanding capability and agency, not merely delivering welfare or legal entitlement; India's own reform tradition - Phule's cross-cutting subaltern-class critique and Ambedkar's structural diagnosis of caste as graded inequality - anticipated this, and the persistent gap between comprehensive affirmative-action policy and its lived benefit (2024 PYQ) shows that closing this gap needs capability-building measures alongside legal entitlement.

11. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims**: Who founded the Satyashodhak Samaj?
- FACT: **Mains (15 marks, 2024 GS-I PYQ, verbatim)**: Despite Comprehensive policies for equity and social justice, underprivileged sections are not yet getting the full benefits of affirmative action envisaged by the Constitution. Comment.
- FACT: **Mains (15 marks, 2025 GS-I PYQ, verbatim)**: Mahatma Jotirao Phule's writings and efforts of social reforms touched issues of almost all subaltern classes. Discuss.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks)**: Explain Amartya Sen's capability approach and its relevance to measuring social empowerment.

12. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion: [advanced/08_Social-Empowerment.md](#).
- FACT: Modern-Indian-History/basic/10_Socio-Religious-Reform-Movements.md - chronological reform-movement narrative for Phule and contemporaries (do not re-derive here).
- FACT: Social-Justice/basic/07_Scheduled-Castes-Rights-Atrocities-and-Welfare.md and Social-Justice/basic/09_OBC-EWS-and-Social-Mobility.md - reservation doctrine and welfare-scheme detail.
- FACT: [02_Caste-System-Structure-and-Contemporary-Dynamics.md](#) - Sanskritisation as a mobility channel.

13. Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

Core-only. Empowerment answers must show how an entitlement becomes a usable capability and a lived outcome; they must not replace social analysis with legal doctrine.

13.1 Directive-to-structure map

Demand family	What is tested	Structure that scores
Comment affirmative-action gap	Input-to-outcome conversion	entitlement -> conversion barriers -> outcome gap -> capability response
Discuss Phule	Cross-cutting diagnosis	caste -> gender -> peasant class -> organisation/writings -> legacy
Explain empowerment	Welfare versus capability/agency	resources -> real freedom -> voice -> outcome
Assess mobility	Formal versus substantive mobility	channel -> gain -> residual stigma/closure -> verdict
Critically examine reform	Incremental safeguards versus structural hierarchy	policy gains -> informal persistence -> balanced conclusion

13.2 Thesis bank

- **T1: FACT:** Formal entitlement is necessary but not sufficient; its conversion into empowerment depends on prior schooling, information, mobility, health and freedom from stigma.
- **T2: FACT:** Phule's force lies in linking caste, gender and peasant-class subordination rather than treating one as an isolated reform problem.
- **T3: FACT:** Ambedkar's graded-inequality diagnosis explains why formal equality can coexist with residual social closure.

13.3 Mark-scaled spines

10 marks - welfare versus empowerment. Define Sen's capability approach, contrast benefit receipt with real freedom to use it, give one conversion barrier and one agency outcome. End with a measured capability-building direction.

15 marks - affirmative action not reaching full benefit (2024 GS-I). Start with T1; map entitlement, conversion factor and outcome. Use E1 and E3, identify information, quality-of-schooling, remoteness and stigma as mechanisms, then route doctrine to Polity/Social Justice. Conclude that expanding quota/coverage alone cannot close the gap.

15 marks - "Formal mobility is not necessarily substantive social empowerment." Examine. Define formal mobility as observable change in income, education or occupation and substantive mobility as that change plus social recognition, secure voice and freedom from stigma. Use education/urban non-farm work as mobility channels, then test whether marriage, housing, local participation or workplace treatment still reproduce closure. Conclude with E5: mobility becomes empowerment only when the conversion reaches lived agency.

20 marks - Phule, Ambedkar and contemporary empowerment. Use Phule's cross-cutting reform, Ambedkar's graded inequality and Sen's capability lens as three distinct analytical tools. Test formal versus substantive mobility and close with a rights-plus-capability verdict.

13.4 Evidence bank - claim -> named evidence/example -> significance -> limitation

- **E1 - Capability.** *Claim:* equal resources need not yield equal freedom. *Evidence:* Amartya Sen's capability approach. *Significance:* identifies conversion factors as the correct site of empowerment analysis. *Limitation:* capability does not make welfare inputs unimportant.
- **E2 - Cross-cutting reform.** *Claim:* social disadvantage is interlinked. *Evidence:* Jyotirao and Savitribai Phule and Satyashodhak Samaj, cross-linked to Modern History. *Significance:* gives caste, girls' education and peasant-class evidence for the 2025 demand. *Limitation:* chronology/writings detail remains with History.
- **E3 - Structural persistence.** *Claim:* hierarchy is self-reinforcing. *Evidence:* B.R. Ambedkar's graded inequality and annihilation-of-caste argument. *Significance:* explains informal hierarchy after formal legal change. *Limitation:* reservation doctrine is routed to Polity/Social Justice.

- **E4 - Measurement caution.** *Claim:* aggregate deprivation does not equal individual agency. *Evidence:* NITI Aayog's 2024 MPI discussion paper (2022-23 estimate). *Significance:* supports a multidimensional frame. *Limitation:* an estimate is neither a current headcount nor proof of an empowerment outcome.
- **E5 - Mobility boundary.** *Claim:* formal mobility can stop short of substantive empowerment. *Evidence:* education, urban migration and non-farm work can alter income or occupation, while marriage, housing, workplace treatment and local participation may retain stigma or closure. *Significance:* makes "formal versus substantive mobility" an independently answerable 15-mark demand. *Limitation:* do not infer either persistent stigma or social recognition from income/occupation alone; establish the relevant setting.

13.5 Balance bank and verdict scaffolds

- ANALYSIS: Do not call every policy failure a design failure: implementation and conversion barriers may be decisive.
- ANALYSIS: Do not call income/occupation mobility full social empowerment if recognition and freedom from stigma lag.
- ANALYSIS: Do not collapse Phule into Ambedkar; use their distinct diagnoses.
- **Verdict:** "Empowerment is completed not when a right is announced, but when a person can convert it into informed, dignified and socially recognised agency."

13.6 Direct Mains demands this Core file must answer alone

Year · Paper · Q	Demand	Core route
2024 · GS-I · Q18	Full benefit of affirmative action	§13.1-13.4, T1, E1/E3
2025 · GS-I · Q11	Phule and almost all subaltern classes	§13.1, T2, E2

Routing correction: Core is now the answer-ready social-analysis owner. Legal and historical owners remain named evidence routes, not prerequisites.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - BOUNDARY CASES, OWNERSHIP AND THE ANSWER SPINE

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Boundary cases, ownership and the answer spine

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Boundary cases · ownership · the answer spine · Evidence chain · Qualified use

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: entitlement without capability - Capability building that works - Formal mobility without recognition...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical.

INDIAN SOCIETY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Social empowerment means expanding capabilities, voice, resources, recognition, representation, legal agency and institutional access for groups facing structural exclusion; redistribution, recognition, participation and autonomy are complementary but not interchangeable routes.
- **Close distinction:** Welfare is not empowerment, formal inclusion is not substantive access, equality is not uniform treatment, reservation is not the whole of social justice, and constitutional rights, statutory commissions, executive schemes and community institutions have different mandates.
- **Evidence / interpretation limit:** Analyse SC, ST, OBC, minority, disability, transgender, elderly and other experiences without merging them; use Articles 14-17, 21, 38, 46 and relevant commissions/laws precisely, separating entitlement, implementation, uptake and outcome.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Empowerment against welfare receipt?

A. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. B. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. C. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. D. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

Answer: A. Explanation: Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Empowerment against welfare receipt?

A. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. B. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. C. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. D. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

Answer: B. Explanation: Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Empowerment against welfare receipt?

A. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. B. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. C. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. D. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.

Answer: C. Explanation: Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Empowerment against welfare receipt?

A. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. B. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. C. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. D. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over.

Answer: D. Explanation: Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The capability approach?

A. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. B. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. C. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. D. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

Answer: A. Explanation: Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being

educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The capability approach?

A. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. B. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. C. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. D. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.

Answer: B. Explanation: Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The capability approach?

A. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. B. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. C. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. D. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

Answer: C. Explanation: Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The capability approach?

A. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. B. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. C. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. D. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.

Answer: D. Explanation: Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Agency view against welfare view?

A. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. B. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. C. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. D. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

Answer: A. Explanation: A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Agency view against welfare view?

A. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. B. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. C. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. D. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

Answer: B. Explanation: A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Agency view against welfare view?

A. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. B. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. C. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. D. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and

peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time.

Answer: C. Explanation: A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Agency view against welfare view?

A. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. B. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. C. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. D. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency.

Answer: D. Explanation: A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Three-stage conversion chain?

A. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. B. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. C. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. D. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Three-stage conversion chain?

A. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. B. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. C. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. D. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.

Answer: B. Explanation: Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Three-stage conversion chain?

A. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. B. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. C. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. D. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

Answer: C. Explanation: Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Three-stage conversion chain?

A. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. B. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. C. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. D. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

Answer: D. Explanation: Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Naming the conversion factors?

A. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. B. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. C. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. D. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

Answer: A. Explanation: The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Naming the conversion factors?

A. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. B. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. C. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. D. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here.

Answer: B. Explanation: The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Naming the conversion factors?

A. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. B. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. C. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. D. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above.

Answer: C. Explanation: The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Naming the conversion factors?

A. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. B. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. C. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. D. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage.

Answer: D. Explanation: The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Open and closed stratification?

A. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. B. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. C. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. D. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

Answer: A. Explanation: An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Open and closed stratification?

A. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. B. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. C. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. D. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time.

Answer: B. Explanation: An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Open and closed stratification?

A. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. B. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. C. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. D. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here.

Answer: C. Explanation: An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Open and closed stratification?

A. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. B. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. C. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. D. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by

birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.

Answer: D. Explanation: An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Formal and substantive mobility?

A. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. B. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. C. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. D. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time.

Answer: A. Explanation: Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Formal and substantive mobility?

A. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. B. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. C. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. D. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above.

Answer: B. Explanation: Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Formal and substantive mobility?

A. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. B. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. C. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as

completed social empowerment. D. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished.

Answer: C. Explanation: Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Formal and substantive mobility?

A. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. B. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. C. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. D. Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

Answer: D. Explanation: Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Phule's cross-cutting critique?

A. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. B. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. C. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. D. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished.

Answer: A. Explanation: Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Phule's cross-cutting critique?

A. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. B. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. C. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. D. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.

Answer: B. Explanation: Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Phule's cross-cutting critique?

A. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. B. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. C. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. D. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.

Answer: C. Explanation: Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Phule's cross-cutting critique?

A. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. B. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. C. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. D. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time.

Answer: D. Explanation: Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Education as Phule's chosen lever?

A. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. B. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. C. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. D. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished.

Answer: A. Explanation: Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Education as Phule's chosen lever?

A. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. B. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. C. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. D. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.

Answer: B. Explanation: Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Education as Phule's chosen lever?

A. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. B. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. C. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. D. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement.

Answer: C. Explanation: Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Education as Phule's chosen lever?

A. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. B. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. C. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. D. Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here.

Answer: D. Explanation: Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Ambedkar's graded inequality?

A. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. B. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. C. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. D. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.

Answer: A. Explanation: B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Ambedkar's graded inequality?

A. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. B. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. C. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. D. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.

Answer: B. Explanation: B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Ambedkar's graded inequality?

A. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. B. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. C. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. D. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.

Answer: C. Explanation: B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Ambedkar's graded inequality?

A. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. B. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. C. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. D. B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above.

Answer: D. Explanation: B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Why graded inequality is self-reinforcing?

A. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. B. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. C. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. D. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.

Answer: A. Explanation: Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Why graded inequality is self-reinforcing?

A. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. B. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. C. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. D. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.

Answer: B. Explanation: Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Why graded inequality is self-reinforcing?

A. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. B. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. C. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group

improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. D. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.

Answer: C. Explanation: Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Why graded inequality is self-reinforcing?

A. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. B. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. C. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. D. Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished.

Answer: D. Explanation: Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Annihilation of caste?

A. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. B. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. C. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. D. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.

Answer: A. Explanation: Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Annihilation of caste?

A. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. B. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. C. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. D. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.

Answer: B. Explanation: Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Annihilation of caste?

A. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. B. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. C. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. D. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.

Answer: C. Explanation: Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Annihilation of caste?

A. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. B. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. C. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. D. Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.

Answer: D. Explanation: Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Phule and Ambedkar as complementary?

A. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. B. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. C. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. D. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.

Answer: A. Explanation: Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Phule and Ambedkar as complementary?

A. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. B. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. C. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. D. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer.

Answer: B. Explanation: Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Phule and Ambedkar as complementary?

A. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. B. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. C. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. D. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional

Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.

Answer: C. Explanation: Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Phule and Ambedkar as complementary?

A. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. B. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. C. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. D. Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.

Answer: D. Explanation: Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Where the affirmative-action gap sits?

A. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. B. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. C. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. D. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.

Answer: A. Explanation: The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Where the affirmative-action gap sits?

A. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. B. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. C. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. D. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per

cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.

Answer: B. Explanation: The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Where the affirmative-action gap sits?

A. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. B. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. C. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. D. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility.

Answer: C. Explanation: The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Where the affirmative-action gap sits?

A. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. B. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. C. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. D. The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement.

Answer: D. Explanation: The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Capability-building complements?

A. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. B. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. C. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. D. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer.

Answer: A. Explanation: Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Capability-building complements?

A. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. B. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. C. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. D. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical.

Answer: B. Explanation: Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Capability-building complements?

A. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. B. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. C. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. D. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical.

Answer: C. Explanation: Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Capability-building complements?

A. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. B. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. C. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. D. Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.

Answer: D. Explanation: Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Dated multidimensional anchor?

A. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. B. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. C. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. D. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer.

Answer: A. Explanation: The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Dated multidimensional anchor?

A. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. B. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. C. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. D. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical.

Answer: B. Explanation: The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dated multidimensional anchor?

A. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. B. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. C. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. D. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility.

Answer: C. Explanation: The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dated multidimensional anchor?

A. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. B. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. C. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being

educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. D. The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.

Answer: D. Explanation: The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Entitlement without capability?

A. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. B. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. C. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. D. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers.

Answer: A. Explanation: A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Entitlement without capability?

A. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. B. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. C. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. D. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility.

Answer: B. Explanation: A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Entitlement without capability?

A. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. B. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. C. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. D. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.

Answer: C. Explanation: A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Entitlement without capability?

A. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. B. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. C. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. D. A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer.

Answer: D. Explanation: A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Capability building that works?

A. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. B. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. C. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. D. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility.

Answer: A. Explanation: A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the

gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Capability building that works?

A. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. B. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. C. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. D. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers.

Answer: B. Explanation: A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Capability building that works?

A. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. B. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. C. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. D. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency.

Answer: C. Explanation: A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Capability building that works?

A. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. B. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. C. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. D. A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical.

Answer: D. Explanation: A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Formal mobility without recognition?

A. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. B. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. C. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. D. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over.

Answer: A. Explanation: A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Formal mobility without recognition?

A. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. B. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. C. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. D. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency.

Answer: B. Explanation: A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Formal mobility without recognition?

A. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. B. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. C. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. D. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs

capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

Answer: C. Explanation: A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Formal mobility without recognition?

A. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. B. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. C. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. D. A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility.

Answer: D. Explanation: A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Examination ownership audit?

A. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. B. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. C. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. D. Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over.

Answer: A. Explanation: Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Examination ownership audit?

A. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. B. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. C. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. D. Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.

Answer: B. Explanation: Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Examination ownership audit?

A. A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. B. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. C. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. D. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.

Answer: C. Explanation: Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Examination ownership audit?

A. The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. B. An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. C. Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. D. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers.

Answer: D. Explanation: Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Two direct General Studies Paper-I Mains demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table and each is recorded with its exact routing status, because in both cases the audited ledger names a different owner. The 2024 Q18 demand on underprivileged sections not yet receiving the full benefits of affirmative action is routed in the audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger to the Social Justice concept-and-welfare-state owner, while this owner's table claims it as a core route. The 2025 Q11 demand on Mahatma Jotirao Phule's writings and social reform efforts is routed in the same ledger to the Modern Indian History socio-religious reform-movements owner, while this owner's table claims it as a core route. Both conflicts are stated openly here and neither is resolved by assertion; the answers below are written strictly from the Social Empowerment sociological spine and claim no reservation doctrine, welfare-scheme architecture or reform-movement chronology owned elsewhere. The wording of both demands was confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 General Studies Paper-I question papers. No marking scheme, official key or model answer of the Union Public Service Commission is held locally, and none is reproduced or inferred.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Define the central concept and separate it from the nearest social or legal category. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace the historical and institutional setting instead of assuming a timeless practice. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated

social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Explain the norm, incentive, network, power or agency mechanism producing the outcome. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Use one named Indian community, movement, region, institution or source-dated dataset. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Qualify the pattern through intersectionality, regional variation, causation and implementation limits. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

5. Indian applications and PYQ mapping

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I PYQ (15 marks, verbatim):** "Despite Comprehensive policies for equity and social justice, underprivileged sections are not yet getting the full benefits of affirmative action envisaged by the Constitution. Comment." The expected answer: affirm the gap, explain it through implementation-capacity limits, unequal starting capability (illiteracy, remoteness, information asymmetry) and residual social stigma limiting effective uptake of affirmative-action provisions, and argue for a capability-building complement to legal entitlement, not merely wider or larger entitlements alone.
- **FACT: 2025 GS-I PYQ (15 marks, verbatim):** "Mahatma Jotirao Phule's writings and efforts of social reforms touched issues of almost all subaltern classes. Discuss." The expected answer: demonstrate that Phule's reform agenda spanned caste (critique of Brahminical dominance), gender (girls' education, widow remarriage support) and peasant-class concerns (critique of exploitative agrarian relations), making his sociological diagnosis unusually comprehensive across multiple axes of subaltern disadvantage rather than caste-focused alone.
- **ANALYSIS:** A Scheduled Caste student who qualifies for a reserved seat but cannot use it effectively due to prior schooling deficits illustrates the policy-practice gap the 2024 PYQ addresses.

9. PYQ application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I (15 marks):** affirm the policy-practice gap, explain it through implementation capacity and unequal starting capability, and recommend capability-building as the complement to legal entitlement.
- **FACT: 2025 GS-I (15 marks):** demonstrate Phule's cross-cutting reform agenda (caste, gender,

peasant class) with specific, named examples of his advocacy.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I (15 marks, verbatim):** "Despite Comprehensive policies for equity and social justice, underprivileged sections are not yet getting the full benefits of affirmative action envisaged by the Constitution. Comment." Analytical route: (a) affirm the gap; (b) apply the entitlement-versus-capability-conversion distinction to locate the gap precisely; (c) cite Ambedkar's graded-inequality logic to explain why informal social hierarchy persists despite formal legal equality; (d) recommend capability-building interventions (schooling quality, mentoring, stigma-reduction) as the necessary complement to entitlement expansion.

- **FACT: 2025 GS-I (15 marks, verbatim):** "Mahatma Jotirao Phule's writings and efforts of social reforms touched issues of almost all subaltern classes. Discuss." Analytical route: demonstrate Phule's cross-cutting agenda using the Section 3 diagnostic chain - caste (Brahminical dominance critique), gender (girls' education) and peasant class (agrarian exploitation critique) - and argue this comprehensiveness anticipated the modern capability-approach logic.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I Q18

Demand: Despite Comprehensive policies for equity and social justice, underprivileged sections are not yet getting the full benefits of affirmative action envisaged by the Constitution. Comment. (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks.

Status: Wording confirmed in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-I. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes this row to the Social Justice concept-and-welfare-state owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it; the conflict is recorded openly and this answer uses only the Social Empowerment spine.

Model solution: Accept the premise and then locate it, because comment rewards a diagnosis rather than agreement. The claim is that a comprehensive equity architecture coexists with an incomplete benefit, and the analytical move is to separate three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome. Stage one is the entitlement, which in this case is genuinely comprehensive: a reserved seat, a targeted scheme, a statutory protection. Stage two is the conversion factor, namely whether the intended beneficiary has the prior schooling to meet the standard the entitlement admits her to, the information that the entitlement exists, the mobility and cost tolerance to reach it, the health to sustain it and freedom from the stigma that deters uptake. Stage three is the outcome. Locate the shortfall at stage two, and say why that matters: if the failure is a conversion failure then expanding entitlement coverage, which is the administratively easier response, will not close the gap, whereas if it were a design failure a different entitlement would be required. Explain the persistence with Ambedkar's graded-inequality logic: because each caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the hierarchy supplies its own defenders and informal social closure survives the abolition of formal legal hierarchy, which is precisely why a legally sufficient entitlement can meet a socially insufficient reception. Prove it with boundary cases rather than adjectives: a reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling is entitlement without capability, and a bridge-course and mentoring programme that raises preparation before and during admission is the conversion-stage intervention that closes the gap. Add the measurement caution: the NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 with about 24.8 crore exits between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and that is a dated estimate for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that any programme caused the change. Conclude that the constitutional promise is not defective but incompletely converted, and that schooling quality, information, mentoring and stigma reduction are the complement that entitlement requires. Route reservation doctrine to Polity and Social Justice rather than restating it.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I Q18", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Accept the premise and then locate it, because comment rewards a diagnosis rather than agreement. The claim is that a comprehensive equity architecture coexists with an incomplete benefit, and the analytical move is to separate three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion

factor vs outcome. Stage one is the entitlement, which in this case is genuinely comprehensive: a reserved seat, a targeted scheme, a statutory protection. Stage two is the conversion factor, namely whether the intended beneficiary has the prior schooling to meet the standard the entitlement admits her to, the information that the entitlement exists, the mobility and cost tolerance to reach it, the health to sustain it and freedom from the stigma that deters uptake. Stage three is the outcome. Locate the shortfall at stage two, and say why that matters: if the failure is a conversion failure then expanding entitlement coverage, which is the administratively easier response, will not close the gap, whereas if it were a design failure a different entitlement would be required. Explain the persistence with Ambedkar's graded-inequality logic: because each caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the hierarchy supplies its own defenders and informal social closure survives the abolition of formal legal hierarchy, which is precisely why a legally sufficient entitlement can meet a socially insufficient reception. Prove it with boundary cases rather than adjectives: a reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling is entitlement without capability, and a bridge-course and mentoring programme that raises preparation before and during admission is the conversion-stage intervention that closes the gap. Add the measurement caution: the NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 with about 24.8 crore exits between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and that is a dated estimate for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that any programme caused the change. Conclude that the constitutional promise is not defective but incompletely converted, and that schooling quality, information, mentoring and stigma reduction are the complement that entitlement requires. Route reservation doctrine to Polity and Social Justice rather than restating it.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Define the central concept and separate it from the nearest social or legal category. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace the historical and institutional setting instead of assuming a timeless practice. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Explain the norm, incentive, network, power or agency mechanism producing the outcome. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Use one named Indian community, movement, region, institution or source-dated dataset. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Qualify the pattern through intersectionality, regional variation, causation and implementation limits. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Accept the premise and then locate it, because comment rewards a diagnosis rather than agreement. The claim is that a comprehensive equity architecture coexists with an incomplete benefit, and the analytical move is to separate three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome. Stage one is the entitlement, which in this case is genuinely comprehensive: a reserved seat, a targeted scheme, a statutory protection. Stage two is the conversion factor, namely whether the intended beneficiary has the prior schooling to meet the standard the entitlement admits her to, the information that the entitlement exists, the mobility and cost tolerance to reach it, the health to sustain it and freedom from the stigma that deters uptake. Stage three is the outcome. Locate the shortfall at stage two, and say why that matters: if the failure is a conversion

failure then expanding entitlement coverage, which is the administratively easier response, will not close the gap, whereas if it were a design failure a different entitlement would be required. Explain the persistence with Ambedkar's graded-inequality logic: because each caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the hierarchy supplies its own defenders and informal social closure survives the abolition of formal legal hierarchy, which is precisely why a legally sufficient entitlement can meet a socially insufficient reception. Prove it with boundary cases rather than adjectives: a reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling is entitlement without capability, and a bridge-course and mentoring programme that raises preparation before and during admission is the conversion-stage intervention that closes the gap. Add the measurement caution: the NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 with about 24.8 crore exits between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and that is a dated estimate for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that any programme caused the change. Conclude that the constitutional promise is not defective but incompletely converted, and that schooling quality, information, mentoring and stigma reduction are the complement that entitlement requires. Route reservation doctrine to Polity and Social Justice rather than restating it.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I Q18", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 GS-I Q11

Demand: Mahatma Jotirao Phule's writings and efforts of social reforms touched issues of almost all subaltern classes. Discuss. (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks.

Status: Wording confirmed in the locally held official 2025 General Studies Paper-I. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes this row to the Modern Indian History socio-religious reform-movements owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it; the conflict is recorded openly and this answer supplies the sociological reading without restating the reform-movement chronology owned there.

Model solution: Fix what the question is actually testing before answering: the examinable word is almost all, so the answer must demonstrate breadth across distinct axes of subordination rather than depth on caste alone, and it must show that the breadth was structural rather than incidental. Establish the organising insight first. Phule identified Brahminical ritual dominance as maintaining not only caste hierarchy but also women's exclusion from learning and the subjugation of the peasant cultivator within the same ideological structure, which is why his reform programme attacks them together instead of sequentially. Now prove each axis. On caste, his critique targeted ritual dominance and the religious sanction that legitimised exclusion, and the Satyashodhak Samaj was the organisational vehicle through which that critique became practice. On gender, he worked with Savitribai Phule to make education for girls a central intervention, which is a capability-building measure in the strict sense because it changes what a person can subsequently do rather than what she is given. On peasant class, he criticised exploitative agrarian relations, which extends the subaltern category beyond ritual status into productive relations. Then supply the comparative claim that the directive quietly requires: most contemporaneous reform effort worked a single axis, such as widow remarriage alone or caste alone, so Phule's simultaneity is the distinguishing feature and not merely the volume of his output. Add the analytical payoff. Because he treated education as the lever, his diagnosis anticipates the modern distinction between an entitlement and the capability needed to use it, though he must not be described as a direct precursor of any later theory. Qualify honestly: the detailed chronology of his writings and organisations belongs to the reform-movement owner and is cross-linked rather than restated, and Phule's diagnosis is not interchangeable with Ambedkar's structural account of graded inequality, since Phule supplies breadth while Ambedkar supplies the reproduction mechanism. Conclude that the proposition holds on the evidence of three simultaneous axes and one organisational vehicle, with the qualification that comprehensiveness of diagnosis is not the same as completeness of outcome.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 GS-I Q11”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Fix what the question is actually testing before answering: the examinable word is almost all, so the answer must demonstrate breadth across distinct axes of subordination rather than depth on caste alone, and it must show that the breadth was structural rather than incidental. Establish the organising insight first. Phule identified Brahminical ritual dominance as maintaining not only caste hierarchy but also women's exclusion from learning and the subjugation of the peasant cultivator within the same ideological structure, which is why his reform programme attacks them together instead of sequentially. Now prove each axis. On caste, his critique targeted ritual dominance and the religious sanction that legitimised exclusion, and the Satyashodhak Samaj was the organisational vehicle through which that critique became practice. On gender, he worked with Savitribai Phule to make education for girls a central intervention, which is a capability-building measure in the strict sense because it changes what a person can subsequently do rather than what she is given. On peasant class, he criticised exploitative agrarian relations, which extends the subaltern category beyond ritual status into productive relations. Then supply the comparative claim that the directive quietly requires: most contemporaneous reform effort worked a single axis, such as widow remarriage alone or caste alone, so Phule's simultaneity is the distinguishing feature and not merely the volume of his output. Add the analytical payoff. Because he treated education as the lever, his diagnosis anticipates the modern distinction between an entitlement and the capability needed to use it, though he must not be described as a direct precursor of any later theory. Qualify honestly: the detailed chronology of his writings and organisations belongs to the reform-movement owner and is cross-linked rather than restated, and Phule's diagnosis is not interchangeable with Ambedkar's structural account of graded inequality, since Phule supplies breadth while Ambedkar supplies the reproduction mechanism. Conclude that the proposition holds on the evidence of three simultaneous axes and one organisational vehicle, with the qualification that comprehensiveness of diagnosis is not the same as completeness of outcome.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Mahatma Jotirao Phule's writings and efforts of social reforms touched issues of almost all subaltern classes. Discuss. (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Fix what the question is actually testing before answering: the examinable word is almost all, so the answer must demonstrate breadth across distinct axes of subordination rather than depth on caste alone, and it must show that the breadth was structural rather than incidental. Establish the organising insight first. Phule identified Brahminical ritual dominance as maintaining not only caste hierarchy but also women's exclusion from learning and the subjugation of the peasant cultivator within the same ideological structure, which is why his reform programme attacks them together instead of sequentially. Now prove each axis. On caste, his critique targeted ritual dominance and the religious sanction that legitimised exclusion, and the Satyashodhak Samaj was the organisational vehicle through which that critique became practice. On gender, he worked with Savitribai Phule to make education for girls a central intervention, which is a capability-building measure in the strict sense because it changes what a person can subsequently do rather than what she is given. On peasant class, he criticised exploitative agrarian relations, which extends the subaltern category beyond ritual status into productive relations. Then supply the comparative claim that the directive quietly requires: most contemporaneous reform effort worked a single axis, such as widow remarriage alone or caste alone, so Phule's simultaneity is the distinguishing feature and not merely the volume of his output. Add the analytical payoff. Because he treated education as the lever, his diagnosis anticipates the modern distinction between an entitlement and the capability needed to use it, though he must not be described as a direct precursor of any later theory. Qualify honestly: the detailed chronology of his writings and organisations belongs to the reform-movement owner and is cross-linked rather than restated, and Phule's diagnosis is not interchangeable with

Ambedkar's structural account of graded inequality, since Phule supplies breadth while Ambedkar supplies the reproduction mechanism. Conclude that the proposition holds on the evidence of three simultaneous axes and one organisational vehicle, with the qualification that comprehensiveness of diagnosis is not the same as completeness of outcome.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 GS-I Q11", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain Amartya Sen's capability approach and its relevance to measuring social empowerment. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The capability approach relocates measurement from what a person receives to what she can actually do and be, which makes conversion factors rather than transfers the correct site of empowerment analysis without denying that welfare inputs matter.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.
- A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency.
- Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over.
- The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage.

Qualified conclusion: The capability approach relocates measurement from what a person receives to what she can actually do and be, which makes conversion factors rather than transfers the correct site of empowerment analysis without denying that welfare inputs matter.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain Amartya Sen's capability approach and its relevance to measuring social empowerment....", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The capability approach relocates measurement from what a person receives to what she can actually do and be, which makes conversion factors rather than transfers the correct site of empowerment analysis without denying that welfare inputs matter.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.

Analysis: Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The capability approach relocates measurement from what a person receives to what she can actually do and be, which makes conversion factors rather than transfers the correct site of empowerment analysis without denying that welfare inputs matter.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain Amartya Sen’s capability approach and its relevance to measuring social empowerment....”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish formal social mobility from substantive social mobility using Indian examples. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation and substantive mobility adds recognition and freedom from stigma, so an answer that stops at the first has measured a change without establishing an empowerment.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.
- Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

- A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility.
- Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished.

Qualified conclusion: Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation and substantive mobility adds recognition and freedom from stigma, so an answer that stops at the first has measured a change without establishing an empowerment.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish formal social mobility from substantive social mobility using Indian examples....”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation and substantive mobility adds recognition and freedom from stigma, so an answer that stops at the first has measured a change without establishing an empowerment.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation and substantive mobility adds recognition and freedom from stigma, so an answer that stops at the first has measured a change without establishing an empowerment.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named

evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish formal social mobility from substantive social mobility using Indian examples...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Comment on the claim that despite comprehensive equity policies the underprivileged are not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The gap is best located at the conversion stage, where prior schooling, information, mobility and stigma decide whether an entitlement can be used, so the remedy is capability building alongside entitlement rather than entitlement expansion alone.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.
- The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage.
- The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement.
- Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.
- Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished.

Qualified conclusion: The gap is best located at the conversion stage, where prior schooling, information, mobility and stigma decide whether an entitlement can be used, so the remedy is capability building alongside entitlement rather than entitlement expansion alone.

Demand decoding: The directive **comment** requires a direct position on “Comment on the claim that despite comprehensive equity policies the underprivileged are not...”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The gap is best located at the conversion stage, where prior schooling, information, mobility and stigma decide whether an entitlement can be used, so the remedy is capability building alongside entitlement rather than entitlement expansion alone.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group

variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The gap is best located at the conversion stage, where prior schooling, information, mobility and stigma decide whether an entitlement can be used, so the remedy is capability building alongside entitlement rather than entitlement expansion alone.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Comment on the claim that despite comprehensive equity policies the underprivileged are not...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Discuss the proposition that Phule's writings and reform efforts touched almost all subaltern classes. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Phule's force lies in treating Brahminical ritual dominance, women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as one ideological structure, which makes his diagnosis cross-cutting where most contemporaneous reform was single-axis.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of

the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time.

- Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here.
- Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.
- An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.

Qualified conclusion: Phule's force lies in treating Brahminical ritual dominance, women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as one ideological structure, which makes his diagnosis cross-cutting where most contemporaneous reform was single-axis.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss the proposition that Phule's writings and reform efforts touched almost all subaltern...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Phule's force lies in treating Brahminical ritual dominance, women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as one ideological structure, which makes his diagnosis cross-cutting where most contemporaneous reform was single-axis.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power,

agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Phule's force lies in treating Brahminical ritual dominance, women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as one ideological structure, which makes his diagnosis cross-cutting where most contemporaneous reform was single-axis.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Discuss the proposition that Phule's writings and reform efforts touched almost all subaltern...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess Phule, Ambedkar and the capability approach as three distinct tools for diagnosing social empowerment. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Phule identifies the breadth of subordination, Ambedkar explains why it reproduces itself and the capability approach specifies where an intervention must act, so the three are complementary instruments rather than competing verdicts.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time.
- B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above.
- Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.
- Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.
- Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.
- Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.

Qualified conclusion: Phule identifies the breadth of subordination, Ambedkar explains why it reproduces itself and the capability approach specifies where an intervention must act, so the three are complementary instruments rather than competing verdicts.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess Phule, Ambedkar and the capability approach as three distinct tools for diagnosing...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Phule identifies the breadth of subordination, Ambedkar explains why it reproduces itself and the capability approach specifies where an intervention must act, so the three are complementary instruments rather than competing verdicts.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Phule identifies the breadth of subordination, Ambedkar explains why it reproduces itself and the capability approach specifies where an intervention must act, so the three are complementary instruments rather than competing verdicts.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for

causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess Phule, Ambedkar and the capability approach as three distinct tools for diagnosing...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate whether closing the affirmative-action gap requires wider entitlement or stronger capability conversion. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Entitlement expansion is administratively easier while the binding constraint sits at conversion, so the defensible verdict favours capability building without abandoning entitlement, and it must be argued with boundary cases rather than with an aggregate estimate.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.
- The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage.
- The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement.
- Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.
- The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.
- A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer.
- A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical.

Qualified conclusion: Entitlement expansion is administratively easier while the binding constraint sits at conversion, so the defensible verdict favours capability building without abandoning entitlement, and it must be argued with boundary cases rather than with an aggregate estimate.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on “Evaluate whether closing the affirmative-action gap requires wider entitlement or stronger...”, all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Entitlement expansion is administratively easier while the binding constraint sits at conversion, so the defensible verdict favours capability building without abandoning entitlement, and it must be argued with boundary cases rather than with an aggregate estimate.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
7. **Claim and named evidence:** A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Entitlement expansion is administratively easier while the binding constraint sits at conversion, so the defensible verdict favours capability building without abandoning entitlement, and it must be argued with boundary cases rather than with an aggregate estimate.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

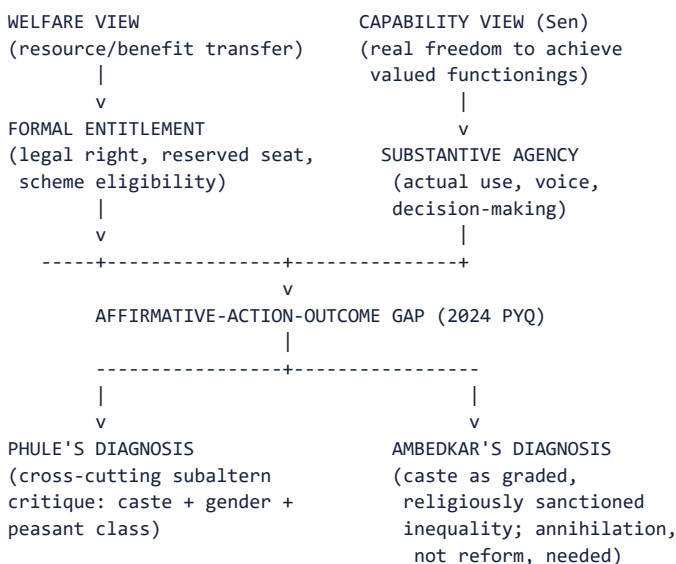
Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For “Evaluate whether closing the affirmative-action gap requires wider entitlement or stronger...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Indian Society | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-I. **Core area:** Capability-versus-welfare theory in depth, the Phule-Ambedkar comparative diagnosis, and the causal architecture of the affirmative-action-outcome gap. **Grounded in:** Amartya Sen's capability approach; Phule's Satyashodhak Samaj; Ambedkar's graded-inequality thesis; NITI Aayog's 2024 multidimensional-poverty discussion paper; audited 2024 and 2025 GS-I Mains PYQs. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* basic/08_Social-Empowerment.md.

1. Architecture



Analytical claim: ANALYSIS: The 2024 PYQ's affirmative-action-outcome gap is illuminated by distinguishing capability from entitlement: formal reservation or scheme eligibility is an important input, but converting it into an outcome requires prior capability (literacy, information, mobility, freedom from stigma) that unequal starting conditions systematically deny to the very groups the policy targets - a structural diagnosis anticipated separately by Phule's cross-cutting subaltern critique and Ambedkar's graded-inequality thesis.

2. Concepts and distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
FACT: Capability approach vs resource/welfare approach	A resource approach measures goods or income received; Sen's capability approach also asks whether a person has real freedom to convert resources into valued functionings. Two people with identical resources can have different capability if illiteracy, ill health or exclusion blocks conversion; this does not make welfare inputs unimportant.
FACT: Phule's cross-cutting critique vs single-axis reform	Many contemporaneous 19th-century reformers addressed a single axis (widow remarriage, or caste alone); Phule's Satyashodhak Samaj explicitly linked Brahminical ritual dominance, women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as interconnected, not separate, problems - a genuinely cross-cutting, proto-intersectional diagnosis.
FACT: Ambedkar's "graded inequality" vs simple hierarchy	Ambedkar argued caste was not a simple linear hierarchy (top to bottom) but a "graded inequality" in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above, making the system self-reinforcing and resistant to piecemeal reform from within - hence his call for "annihilation of caste" rather than internal reform.
ANALYSIS: Entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome	An entitlement (a reserved seat, a scheme) is the policy input; capability-conversion factors (literacy, health, social confidence, absence of stigma) determine whether that input is used; the outcome (actual mobility, income, voice) depends on both - the 2024 PYQ's gap arises specifically at the conversion-factor stage.
ANALYSIS: Formal social mobility vs substantive social mobility	Formal mobility is documented movement (a caste group entering a new occupation or income bracket in aggregate statistics); substantive mobility additionally requires that this movement is accompanied by social recognition and freedom from residual stigma - the two can diverge, as aggregate income gains do not always translate into equal social standing.

3. Detailed causal chain

Capability-conversion chain (2024 PYQ core)

1. Constitutional affirmative action creates an entitlement (reserved seat, targeted scheme, quota).
2. ANALYSIS: Effective use of this entitlement requires prior capability - adequate schooling, information about the entitlement, mobility to access it, and freedom from social stigma that might otherwise deter uptake.
3. ANALYSIS: Where the targeted group's starting capability is itself depressed by generations of exclusion (poor schooling infrastructure in remote or historically excluded areas, for instance), the entitlement's conversion into outcome is blocked at this stage, not at the policy-design stage.
4. ANALYSIS: The resulting "gap" the 2024 PYQ describes is therefore a capability-conversion failure, not necessarily a policy-design failure - an important distinction for a nuanced Mains answer.

Phule's diagnostic chain

1. Phule identified Brahminical ritual dominance as maintaining not only caste hierarchy but also women's exclusion from education and peasant subjugation within the same ideological structure.
2. With Savitribai Phule's educational work, he treated education for girls and oppressed castes as a central capability-building intervention, while also critiquing peasant exploitation; this anticipates parts of a modern capability lens without making him a direct precursor of every later theory.
3. ANALYSIS: His comprehensiveness (the 2025 PYQ's "almost all subaltern classes") is precisely

what distinguishes him from reformers who worked only one axis of disadvantage at a time.

Ambedkar's diagnostic chain

1. Ambedkar rejected the view that caste was a benign division of labour, showing instead that it graded status hierarchically and reproduced itself through religious sanction on endogamy.
2. Because every caste (except the lowest) has an interest in maintaining someone below it, Ambedkar argued piecemeal reform (a single caste improving its own position) would not dismantle the system - only structural annihilation of caste as an institution would.
3. ANALYSIS: This diagnosis directly explains why formal legal equality (post-Independence constitutional guarantee) has not automatically produced substantive social equality - the graded-inequality logic persists informally even where legal hierarchy is abolished.

4. Institutional and reform architecture

- ANALYSIS: **Capability-building complements to entitlement:** early-childhood education quality, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, and targeted skill-bridging programmes are examples of interventions that address the conversion-factor stage the 2024 PYQ's gap points to, rather than expanding entitlement coverage alone.
- ANALYSIS: **Reform-movement legacy institutions (cross-linked):** the chronological institutional history of socio-religious reform movements, including Phule's Satyashodhak Samaj, is treated in Modern-Indian-History/basic/10_Socio-Religious-Reform-Movements.md.

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- ANALYSIS: **Boundary case 1 - entitlement without capability:** a reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace due to weak prior schooling shows entitlement without adequate capability-conversion support.
- ANALYSIS: **Boundary case 2 - capability-building success:** a bridge-course or mentoring programme that brings a reserved-category student's academic preparation up to par before admission shows a capability-conversion intervention closing the 2024 PYQ's gap directly.
- ANALYSIS: **Boundary case 3 - formal mobility without substantive mobility:** a family that has moved into a new, higher-income occupation but still faces informal social exclusion in marriage or local social life illustrates Ambedkar's graded-inequality logic persisting despite formal economic mobility, while Phule's advocacy for a girls' school in Pune alongside his critique of exploitative agrarian relations for peasants shows the cross-cutting reform agenda the 2025 PYQ specifically asks students to establish.

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- ANALYSIS: **Policy-design-versus-conversion-factor trade-off:** expanding entitlement coverage (more reserved seats, larger scholarships) is administratively easier than fixing capability-conversion factors (schooling quality, social stigma), but the 2024 PYQ's gap is located precisely at the harder, conversion-factor stage.
- ANALYSIS: **Aggregate-mobility-versus-social-recognition trade-off:** formal economic mobility statistics can rise even while substantive social recognition lags, so citing only income/occupation data risks overstating actual empowerment.
- ANALYSIS: **Annihilation-versus-gradual-reform trade-off:** Ambedkar's structural "annihilation of caste" framing is analytically powerful but politically and socially slower to realise than incremental reform; contemporary policy in practice combines both incremental legal reform and structural constitutional safeguards.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: Amartya Sen's capability approach distinguishes resource/welfare measures from real freedom to achieve valued functionings.
- FACT: Ambedkar's "graded inequality" concept explains why every caste (except the lowest) has a stake in the hierarchy's persistence, making piecemeal reform structurally limited.

- FACT: Phule's Satyashodhak Samaj addressed caste, gender and peasant-class disadvantage as interlinked, not separate, concerns - the exact basis of the 2025 PYQ.

- CURRENT: NITI Aayog's 2024 discussion paper *Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06* estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28% in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore exits between 2013-14 and 2022-23. These are dated estimates, not a current headcount.

- ANALYSIS: Formal mobility and substantive mobility are analytically distinct outcome measures, frequently conflated in Mains answers.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: The affirmative-action-outcome gap is purely a policy-design failure. -> It is better explained as a capability-conversion-factor failure - the entitlement often exists, but prior capability to use it effectively does not.

- WRONG: Ambedkar's caste critique was primarily about economic inequality. -> His central argument was about graded, religiously sanctioned status inequality, from which economic inequality follows, not the reverse.

- WRONG: Phule's reform work is comparable to reformers who worked only a single-axis issue (such as widow remarriage alone). -> The 2025 PYQ specifically credits Phule with a cross-cutting agenda spanning caste, gender and peasant-class concerns simultaneously.

- WRONG: Rising aggregate mobility statistics prove social empowerment is complete. -> Formal mobility can rise while substantive social recognition and freedom from stigma lag behind.

9. CURRENT: Current-anchor note

- CURRENT: NITI Aayog's 2024 discussion paper estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28% in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore exits between 2013-14 and 2022-23. Cite its date, estimate and period; do not present it as a current 2026 poverty count.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: **2024 GS-I (15 marks, verbatim)**: "Despite Comprehensive policies for equity and social justice, underprivileged sections are not yet getting the full benefits of affirmative action envisaged by the Constitution. Comment." Analytical route: (a) affirm the gap; (b) apply the entitlement-versus-capability-conversion distinction to locate the gap precisely; (c) cite Ambedkar's graded-inequality logic to explain why informal social hierarchy persists despite formal legal equality; (d) recommend capability-building interventions (schooling quality, mentoring, stigma-reduction) as the necessary complement to entitlement expansion.

- FACT: **2025 GS-I (15 marks, verbatim)**: "Mahatma Jotirao Phule's writings and efforts of social reforms touched issues of almost all subaltern classes. Discuss." Analytical route: demonstrate Phule's cross-cutting agenda using the Section 3 diagnostic chain - caste (Brahminical dominance critique), gender (girls' education) and peasant class (agrarian exploitation critique) - and argue this comprehensiveness anticipated the modern capability-approach logic.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: Social empowerment requires closing the gap between formal entitlement and actual capability-conversion; India's own reform tradition - Phule's cross-cutting subaltern critique and Ambedkar's graded-inequality diagnosis - identified this structural problem long before Sen's capability approach formalised it, and the persistent 2024-PYQ gap between affirmative-action policy and lived benefit shows the conversion-factor problem remains unresolved.

1. Distinguish entitlement, capability-conversion factor and outcome as three separate stages.

2. Apply Ambedkar's graded-inequality thesis to explain persistence of informal hierarchy.

3. Apply Phule's cross-cutting diagnosis (caste + gender + peasant class) with named examples.

4. Give one boundary case of entitlement-without-capability and one of successful capability-building.
5. Distinguish formal mobility from substantive mobility explicitly.
6. Flag the policy-design-versus-conversion-factor trade-off.
7. Cross-link reservation doctrine without restating it.
8. Recommend capability-building interventions as the complement to entitlement expansion.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Which concept did Ambedkar use to describe caste as a self-reinforcing, hierarchically graded system?
- FACT: **Mains (15 marks, 2024 GS-I PYQ, verbatim):** Despite Comprehensive policies for equity and social justice, underprivileged sections are not yet getting the full benefits of affirmative action envisaged by the Constitution. Comment.
- FACT: **Mains (15 marks, 2025 GS-I PYQ, verbatim):** Mahatma Jotirao Phule's writings and efforts of social reforms touched issues of almost all subaltern classes. Discuss.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Distinguish between formal social mobility and substantive social mobility with Indian examples.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: [basic/08_Social-Empowerment.md](#).
- FACT: Modern-Indian-History/[basic/10_Socio-Religious-Reform-Movements.md](#) - chronological reform-movement narrative.
- FACT: Social-Justice/[basic/07_Scheduled-Castes-Rights-Atrocities-and-Welfare.md](#) and Social-Justice/[basic/09_OBC-EWS-and-Social-Mobility.md](#) - reservation doctrine and welfare-scheme detail.
- FACT: [advanced/02_Caste-System-Structure-and-Contemporary-Dynamics.md](#) - Sanskritisation as a mobility channel.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Social Empowerment: RAPID CONCEPT AND EVIDENCE MAP

1. **Empowerment against welfare receipt:** Social empowerment is not exhausted by the delivery of welfare benefits, because a person can receive a transfer, a seat or a scheme entitlement and still lack the real freedom to use it, so the examinable question is always what a person can actually do and be rather than what has been handed over.
2. **The capability approach:** Amartya Sen's capability approach holds that development and empowerment should be measured by the real freedoms a person has to achieve valued functionings such as being educated, being healthy and participating in public life, rather than by the resources or income that person receives.
3. **Agency view against welfare view:** A welfare or resource view asks what goods, income or benefits a person receives, while an agency view additionally asks whether that person can make and act on choices that shape her own well-being, and welfare provision remains valuable and rights-based even though receipt alone does not establish agency.
4. **Three-stage conversion chain:** Empowerment analysis separates three stages that the Advanced owner labels entitlement input vs capability-conversion factor vs outcome: the entitlement is the policy input such as a reserved seat or a targeted scheme, the conversion factor decides whether that input can be used, and the outcome is the mobility, income or voice that results.
5. **Naming the conversion factors:** The conversion factors that decide whether an entitlement becomes an outcome are adequate prior schooling, information that the entitlement exists, mobility to reach it, health, social

confidence and freedom from stigma that would otherwise deter uptake, and naming them converts a vague implementation complaint into a diagnosable stage.

6. **Open and closed stratification:** An open stratification system allows movement between social positions on the basis of individual achievement while a closed system fixes position largely by birth-ascribed status, and traditional caste society leaned toward the closed type while contemporary India shows increasing but uneven openness.
7. **Formal and substantive mobility:** Formal mobility is documented movement in income, education or occupation, while substantive mobility additionally requires social recognition, secure voice and freedom from residual stigma, and the two diverge often enough that an aggregate income gain cannot be read as completed social empowerment.
8. **Phule's cross-cutting critique:** Mahatma Jyotirao Phule founded the Satyashodhak Samaj and directed his writings and reform work against Brahminical ritual dominance while treating women's exclusion from education and peasant exploitation as parts of the same ideological structure, which is what distinguishes him from reformers who worked a single axis of disadvantage at a time.
9. **Education as Phule's chosen lever:** Working with Savitribai Phule, Phule made education for girls and for oppressed castes a central empowerment intervention while separately criticising exploitative agrarian relations, and the detailed chronology of the socio-religious reform movements belongs to Modern Indian History and is cross-linked rather than restated here.
10. **Ambedkar's graded inequality:** B.R. Ambedkar argued that caste was not a benign division of labour or a simple top-to-bottom hierarchy but a graded inequality reproduced through religious sanction on endogamy, in which each caste simultaneously looks down on those below and aspires to the position of those above.
11. **Why graded inequality is self-reinforcing:** Because every caste except the lowest has an interest in maintaining someone below it, the system supplies its own defenders at every level, which is why piecemeal reform by a single group improving its own position does not dismantle the structure and why informal hierarchy can persist after formal legal hierarchy is abolished.
12. **Annihilation of caste:** Annihilation of caste is Ambedkar's structural conclusion that the institution itself must be dismantled rather than reformed from within, because a reform strategy that leaves the underlying religious sanction intact cannot end a graded hierarchy, and the constitutional safeguards this conclusion shaped belong doctrinally to Polity and Social Justice.
13. **Phule and Ambedkar as complementary:** Phule supplies a cross-cutting diagnosis that links caste, gender and peasant-class subordination while Ambedkar supplies a structural diagnosis of why hierarchy reproduces itself, so the two must be used as distinct analytical tools rather than collapsed into a single reformist tradition.
14. **Where the affirmative-action gap sits:** The gap between comprehensive equity policy and lived benefit is best located at the conversion stage rather than assumed to be a design failure, and this analytical claim matters because the remedy for a conversion failure is capability building while the remedy for a design failure would be a different entitlement.
15. **Capability-building complements:** Early-childhood and schooling-quality investment, scholarship-plus-mentoring models, bridge and skill-bridging courses and stigma reduction are the interventions that address the conversion stage, and they complement rather than replace entitlement, which is why expanding coverage alone cannot close the gap.
16. **Dated multidimensional anchor:** The NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024 titled Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06 estimated multidimensional poverty at 11.28 per cent in 2022-23 and about 24.8 crore persons exiting multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23, and these are the paper's estimates for a stated period rather than a current headcount or proof that a particular programme caused the change.
17. **Entitlement without capability:** A reserved-category student admitted to a technical institution but unable to keep pace because of weak prior schooling illustrates an entitlement arriving without the capability needed to use it, which is the boundary case that defeats an entitlement-only answer.
18. **Capability building that works:** A bridge course or a scholarship-plus-mentoring programme that raises a student's academic preparation before and during admission illustrates a conversion-stage intervention closing the gap directly, which is the boundary case that makes the recommendation concrete rather than rhetorical.

19. **Formal mobility without recognition:** A family that has moved into a higher-income occupation while still facing informal exclusion in marriage, housing or local social life illustrates graded-inequality logic persisting despite economic mobility, which is the boundary case that separates formal from substantive mobility.
20. **Examination ownership audit:** Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner's own answer-architecture table, namely the 2024 demand on underprivileged sections not receiving the full benefits of affirmative action worth 15 marks and the 2025 demand on Phule's writings and reform efforts worth 15 marks, while the audited routing ledgers name the Social Justice framework owner and the Modern Indian History reform-movements owner respectively, and both wordings were confirmed in the locally held official 2024 and 2025 question papers.

Social Empowerment: CLOSE-OPTION AND CAUSAL TRAPS

- Do not treat welfare provision and social empowerment as the same thing.
- Do not describe the capability approach as a rejection of the importance of welfare inputs.
- Do not call the affirmative-action gap a policy-design failure without testing the conversion stage.
- Do not merge the entitlement, the conversion factor and the outcome into one undifferentiated claim.
- Do not present Phule's reform work as addressing caste alone.
- Do not collapse Phule's diagnosis into Ambedkar's or the reverse.
- Do not describe Ambedkar's caste critique as primarily an economic-inequality argument.
- Do not present Ambedkar as seeking reform of caste from within its religious sanction.
- Do not restate reservation doctrine or scheme entitlement owned by Polity and Social Justice.
- Do not restate the reform-movement chronology owned by Modern Indian History.
- Do not treat rising aggregate mobility statistics as proof that social empowerment is complete.
- Do not present the NITI Aayog estimate as a current-year poverty headcount.
- Do not attribute the multidimensional-poverty change to a named programme.
- Do not invent a scholarship uptake rate, a dropout figure or a caste-wise outcome statistic.

Social Empowerment: ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

DEFINE THE SOCIAL UNIT -> STATE THE BOUNDARY RULE AND WHO IS INCLUDED
 -> GROUP NAMED EVIDENCE BY MECHANISM OF REPRODUCTION OR CHANGE
 -> TEST COUNTER-CASES, REGIONAL VARIATION AND CATEGORY LIMITS
 -> SEPARATE CORRELATION FROM CAUSATION AND LAW FROM SOCIAL ACCEPTANCE
 -> CLOSE WITH A GRADED, POLICY-AWARE VERDICT AND A DATA CAVEAT

Social Empowerment: CURRENT-LINK AND DATA BOUNDARY

No additional live official item was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. Only the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners are used, each with its issuing body and date. The package invents no caste, tribe, demographic or agrarian statistic, no legal or constitutional claim and no policy status.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Two measurement questions

WELFARE VIEW -> what income, goods or benefits were received
AGENCY VIEW -> what the person can actually do, choose and be
SEN -> real freedoms to achieve valued functionings
RULE -> receipt is an input and never by itself an outcome
MUST REMEMBER: Social empowerment means expanding capabilities, voice, resources, recognition, representation, legal agency and institutional access for groups facing structural exclusion; redistribution, recognition, participation and autonomy are complementary but not interchangeable routes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Three-stage chain

ENTITLEMENT -> reserved seat, targeted scheme, statutory right
CONVERSION FACTOR -> schooling, information, mobility, health, stigma
OUTCOME -> mobility, income, recognised voice
DIAGNOSIS -> name the stage before naming the remedy

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Conversion-factor checklist

PRIOR SCHOOLING -> is the entitlement usable at the required standard
INFORMATION -> does the household know the entitlement exists
REACH -> can it be accessed without prohibitive travel or cost
STIGMA -> does social cost deter uptake even when access exists

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Mobility types

OPEN SYSTEM -> position follows achievement
CLOSED SYSTEM -> position follows birth-ascribed status
FORMAL MOBILITY -> documented income, education or occupation change
SUBSTANTIVE MOBILITY -> that change plus recognition and freedom from stigma

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Phule's three axes

CASTE -> critique of Brahminical ritual dominance
GENDER -> girls' education with Savitribai Phule
PEASANT CLASS -> critique of exploitative agrarian relations
ORGANISATION -> Satyashodhak Samaj as the reform vehicle

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Graded inequality

CLAIM -> caste is not benign division of labour
STRUCTURE -> each caste looks down and simultaneously aspires upward
SANCTION -> religious sanction on endogamy reproduces the grade
CONSEQUENCE -> the system supplies defenders at every level

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Reform against annihilation

PIECEMEAL REFORM -> one group improves its own relative position
LIMIT -> the graded structure survives the improvement
ANNIHILATION -> dismantle caste as an institution, not adjust it
BOUNDARY -> constitutional doctrine routed to Polity and Social Justice

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Two diagnoses compared

PHULE -> breadth: caste, gender and peasant class as one structure
AMBEDKAR -> depth: why the structure reproduces itself
SEN -> site: where an intervention must act to change a life
USE -> three distinct tools, never one merged reform narrative

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Locating the gap

ENTITLEMENT EXISTS -> comprehensive equity and social-justice policy
CONVERSION FAILS -> schooling, information, distance, stigma
OUTCOME SHORTFALL -> benefit not fully realised by the target group
REMEDY -> capability building, not entitlement expansion alone

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Estimate card

SOURCE -> NITI Aayog discussion paper of 2024
TITLE -> Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005-06
ESTIMATE -> 11.28 per cent multidimensional poverty in 2022-23
EXITS -> about 24.8 crore persons between 2013-14 and 2022-23
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Welfare is not empowerment, formal inclusion is not substantive access, equality is not uniform treatment, reservation is not the whole of social justice, and constitutional rights, statutory commissions, executive schemes and community institutions have different mandates.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Three boundary cases

ENTITLEMENT WITHOUT CAPABILITY -> admitted seat, weak prior schooling
CAPABILITY BUILT -> bridge course and mentoring before and during study
FORMAL WITHOUT SUBSTANTIVE -> higher income, continuing social exclusion
READING -> each case fixes one link in the conversion chain
EVIDENCE LIMIT: Analyse SC, ST, OBC, minority, disability, transgender, elderly and other experiences without merging them; use Articles 14-17, 21, 38, 46 and relevant commissions/laws precisely, separating entitlement, implementation, uptake and outcome.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Empowerment answer spine

OPEN -> define empowerment as capability and agency, not receipt
BODY -> entitlement, conversion factor and outcome named in order
TEST -> boundary cases that break an entitlement-only claim
CLOSE -> capability-building verdict with a dated estimate caveat